

From Foundation to Autonomy: The 5-Year PE Fitness Spiral

Fitness Module 2026: A Progressive, Inclusive and Ipsative PE Journey

YEARS 7-8: FOUNDATIONAL FLUENCY

- Focus on developing solid basic coordination, and safe bodyweight exercises in game-based environments.

Developing movement competence, autonomy, and lifelong fitness from Year 7 to Year 11

Stephen Grima

YEAR 11: PERSONAL AUTONOMY

Students design and running their own training programs to support lifelong health and well-being.

Year 11 | Personal Design

Independent autonomy and program sustainability.

YEARS 9-10: APPLIED COMPLEXITY

Refining strength and conditioning patterns while introducing "Hybrid Fitness" that combines multiple physical demands.

Year 9 | Strength & Conditioning

Increasing training volume and intensity safely.

Curriculum Theme & Progression Focus

Progression Focus

THE IPSATIVE ASSESSMENT FRAMEWORK



The Ipsative Principle

Assessment is progress-oriented; learners are measured solely against their own starting points.

The Consistent Fitness Battery

Test Type	Name	Measured Component
Coordination	Hexagon Test	Agility, footwork patterns, and direction change
Strength	Push Test	Core
Cardio	Run Test	Cardio

Fitness Module 2026



Through the lens of AI

PE Journey 2026: The 5-Year Scaffolding Pathway

This curriculum follows a '**Spiral Learning**' model, where movement patterns and tactical concepts are revisited with increasing complexity. Students progress from fundamental principles in Year 7 to personal autonomy and lifelong fitness by Year 11, moving through four interconnected learning domains.

5-Year Learning Scaffold

Year 11: Autonomy & Lifelong Practice

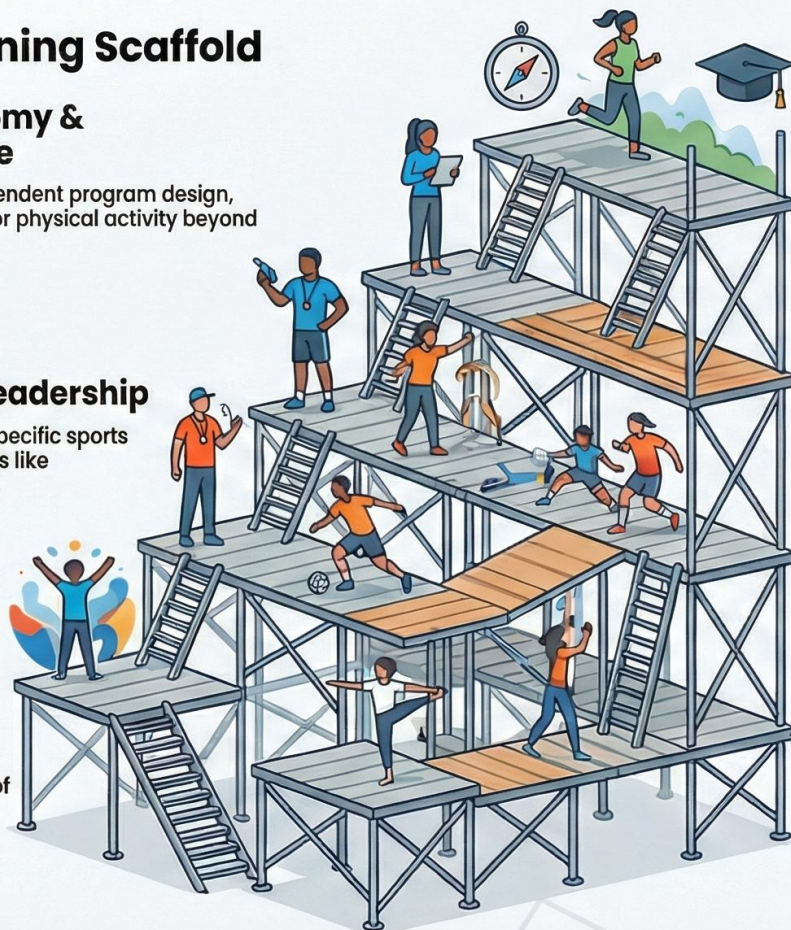
Emphasis shifts to independent program design, agency, and preparing for physical activity beyond school.

Years 8–10: Application & Leadership

Students apply skills to specific sports and begin assuming roles like coaching and officiating.

Year 7: Foundations & Principles

Focuses on movement quality, basic principles of play, and establishing a sense of belonging.



Fitness	Games (Invasion / Net)	Individual Activities	Outdoor & Recreation
Personal Design	Rugby / Volleyball	Mind-Body Activities	Independence & Agency
Hybrid Fitness	Football / Badminton	Choice (Athletics/Martial Arts/Swim)	Leadership & Planning
Strength & Conditioning	Basketball / Short Tennis	Athletics (Performance)	Adaptation & Responsibility
Functional Fitness	Handball / Smashball	Gymnastics	Application & Cooperation
Movement Quality	Principles / Principles	Educational Dance	Foundations & Belonging

Purpose of the Module



Develop physically literate learners



Promote lifelong health and fitness habits



Build movement competence progressively



Foster learner autonomy and self-regulation

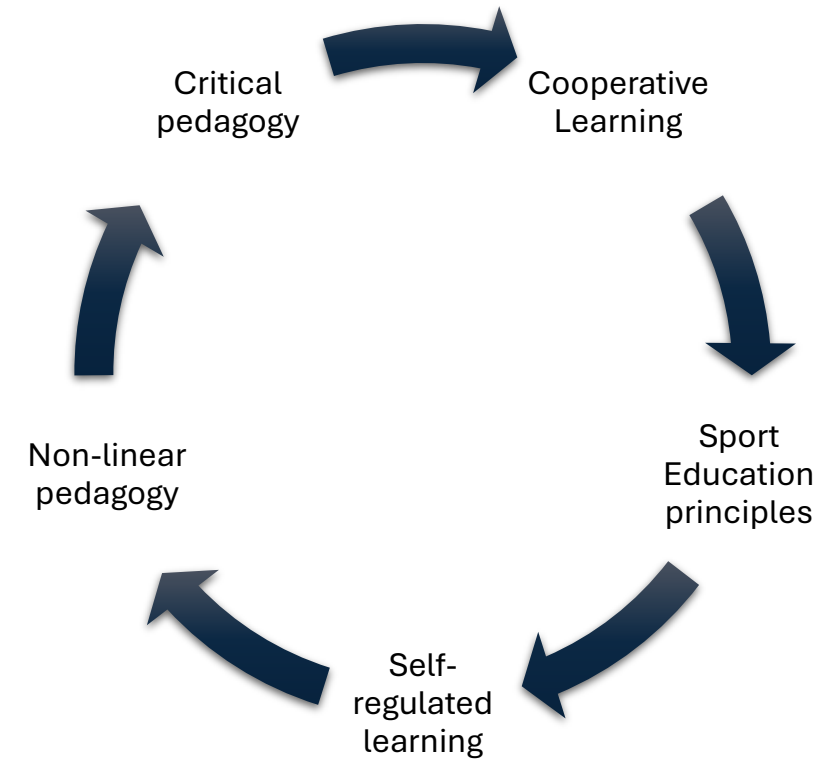


Fitness as personal growth, not comparison

Curriculum Structure Across Years 7–11

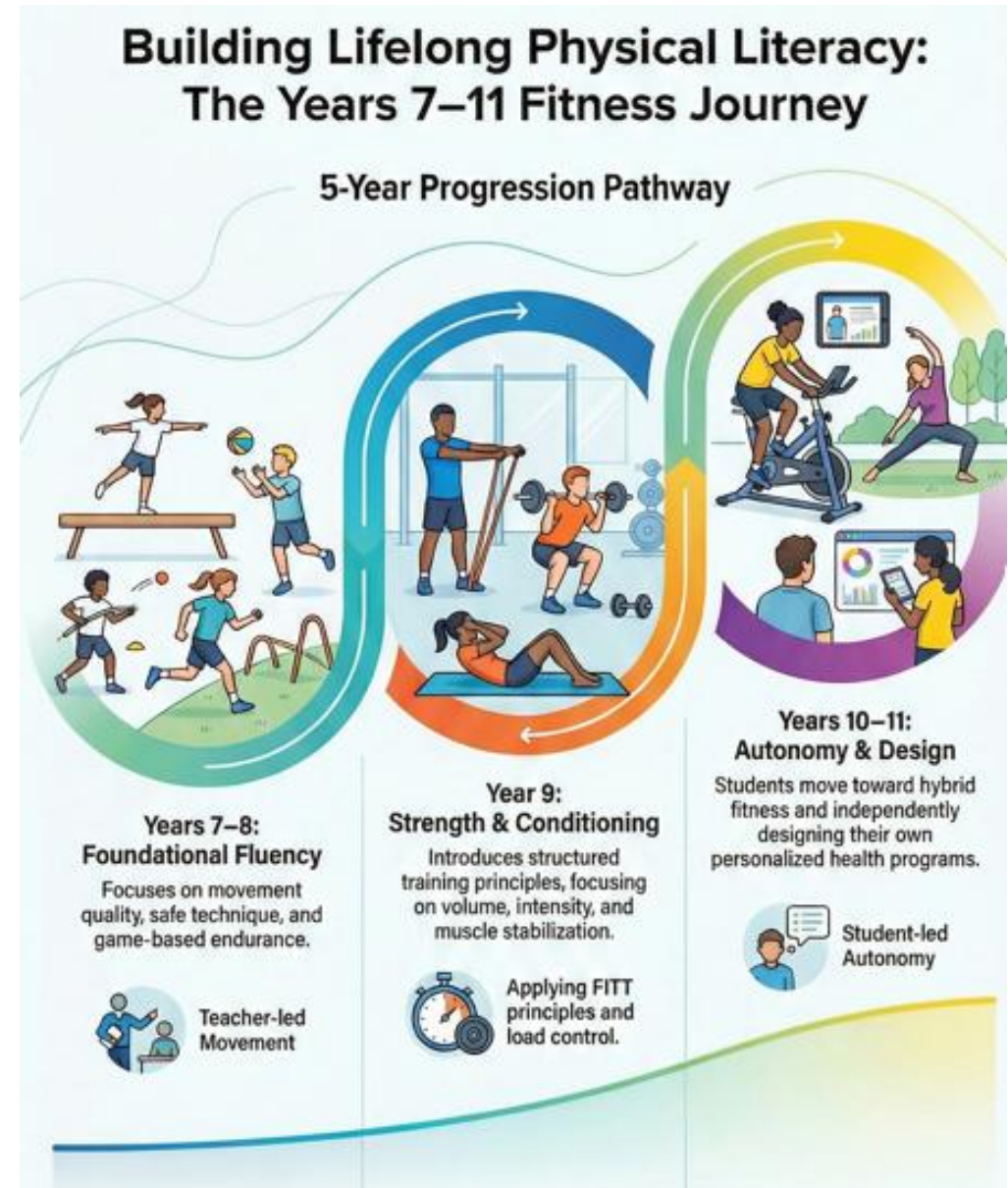


Pedagogical Foundations



The Ipsative Core

- Assessment against personal starting points
- Baseline vs post-test comparison
- Personal goal setting
- Growth over competition
- Improvement is success



Common Fitness Battery

HEXAGON TEST (AGILITY)



SCORING

Number of successful jumps in 30s



TAPE/CHALK,
STOPWATCH

PLANK TO TECHNICAL FAILURE (STRENGTH)



Held a straight head-to-heel line; stop when hips shift or technique breaks.



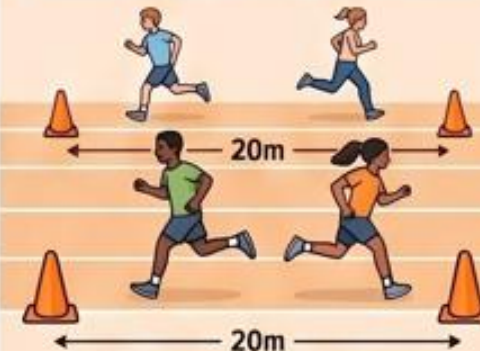
SCORING

Total time held with correct form



MAT,
STOPWATCH

2-MINUTE SHUTTLE TEST (ENDURANCE)



Run continuously between two lines 20m apart.



SCORING

Total distance (Shuttles × 20m)



2 CONES
(20m apart),
STOPWATCH

STANDARD SETUP REQUIREMENTS

TEST	EQUIPMENT NEEDED	SCORING METRIC
 HEXAGON	Tape/Chalk, Stopwatch	Number of successful jumps in 30s
 PLANK	Mat, Stopwatch	Total time held with correct form
 SHUTTLE	2 Cones (20m apart), Stopwatch	Total distance (Shuttles × 20m)

Why Standardisation Matters

CONSISTENT
PROTOCOLS

FAIR COMPARISONS
OVER TIME

RELIABLE LEARNER-
LED DATA

SUPPORTS LONG-TERM
IPSATIVE PROGRESS

MASTERING MOVEMENT PROGRESSIONS

(Development)

THE 4-STEP PROGRESSION STRATEGY



THE IPSATIVE GROWTH CYCLE





Cognitive
understanding



Decision-making



Personal reflection



Physical
performance



Values, motivation,
teamwork

Holistic Assessment Framework

Physical

Cognitive

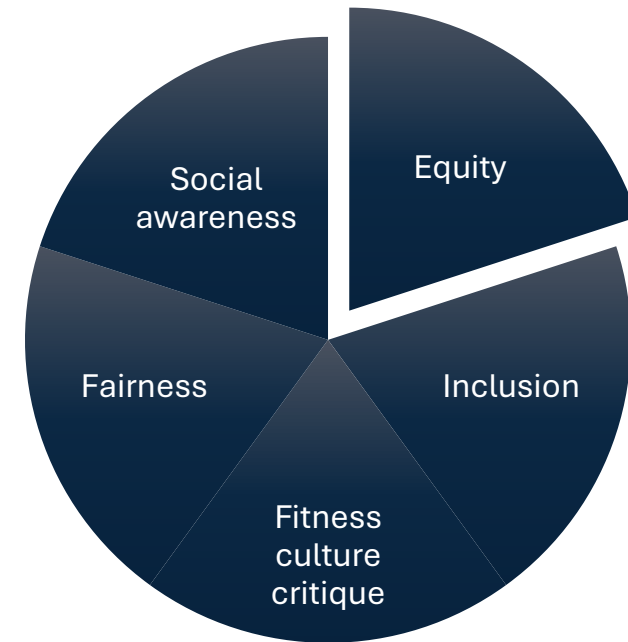
Affective

Formative Assessment

- Observation
- Peer feedback
- Self-assessment
- Reflection journals
- Goal setting



Values & Critical Pedagogy



FIVE LEVELS OF DIFFICULTY



Inclusion and Equity

- Differentiated tasks
- Personal benchmarks
- Reduced elitism
- Accessible success for all

Why Ipsative Assessment Is Transformational

- Traditional PE: comparison-based.
- The move: growth-based.
- Promotes resilience, confidence, equity.



The Spiral Curriculum Approach

Learners revisit core concepts in increasingly complex ways, focusing on "repetition without repetition."